

Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana

Data-Driven Policy Recommendations Brief

Prepared for: Women & Child Development Department, Government of Maharashtra | Submitted by: MahaIT Data Analytics Division

Analysis Period: July 2024 – April 2026 | Dataset: 5,00,000 synthetic records (1 record = 50.6 real beneficiaries)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This brief presents five data-backed recommendations derived from an end-to-end analysis of the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana — Maharashtra's flagship women's direct benefit transfer scheme. The analysis covers 2.34 crore applications, 17 installment disbursements totalling Rs 33,232 crore, and post-audit suspension of 26.34 lakh beneficiaries. Three systemic issues emerge consistently across all analytical dimensions: eKYC infrastructure gaps, uneven geographic coverage, and inadequate fraud detection controls at offline registration channels.

KEY METRICS AT A GLANCE

Metric	Synthetic Value	Real Equivalent	Source
Total Applications	5,00,000 (synthetic)	2.34 crore	WCD Department
Active Beneficiaries	3,74,000 (74.8%)	1.75 crore	WCD Audit Apr 2026
Suspended – Ineligible	55,500 (11.1%)	26.34 lakh	WCD Audit Jun 2025
eKYC Failure Suspensions	16,487 (29.7% of susp)	~7.8 lakh	This Analysis
Male Fraud Registrants	283 (synthetic)	14,298	WCD Report 2025
Exchequer Loss (Male Fraud)	Rs 1.01 Cr (synthetic)	Rs 21.44 Cr	WCD Report 2025
Total Disbursed	Rs 1,094 Cr (synthetic)	Rs 33,232 Cr	Budget Speech FY25
Worst Performing Division	Amravati (19.96% susp)	Amravati	This Analysis
Highest Fraud Risk Channel	Gram Panchayat Office	GP Office	This Analysis
Lowest Active Rate District	Akola (73.98%)	Akola	This Analysis

POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

R1	Deploy Proactive eKYC Camps in Amravati and Nagpur Divisions	HIGH
Data Finding: eKYC failure is the single largest suspension reason, accounting for 29.7% of all suspended beneficiaries (16,487 synthetic / ~7.8 lakh real). Amravati Division has the highest suspension rate (19.96%) and lowest overall active rate — driven primarily by rural women unable to complete eKYC independently. The Nari Shakti Doot App shows the lowest fraud rate, confirming that digital, Aadhaar-authenticated channels work — but only where internet access and digital literacy exist. Recommendation: MahaIT should deploy mobile eKYC camps in the 5 lowest-performing districts (Akola, Washim, Yavatmal, Buldhana, Amravati) in partnership with district administration. Each camp should be equipped with biometric devices, Aadhaar seeding terminals, and trained Anganwadi supervisors. A 30-day SMS reminder campaign should precede each camp, targeting beneficiaries whose eKYC status = Pending or Failed/Expired in the MahaIT portal.		

Expected Impact: Estimated reinstatement of 5–7 lakh suspended women. Reduction of Amravati division suspension rate from 19.96% to below 12%. Improved DBT success rate from 72.7% to above 85% in targeted districts.

R2 Mandate Digital Registration Channels for All Future Scheme Enrolments

HIGH

Data Finding: Analysis of fraud rates by application channel reveals a clear digital advantage: Gram Panchayat Office registrations showed the highest fraud rate while the Nari Shakti Doot App showed the lowest. GP Office registrations lack real-time Aadhaar authentication and biometric verification, creating an environment where identity fraud goes undetected for an average of 10 months (as seen with male registrants). Of 14,298 male fraudsters detected, the majority registered through offline channels.

Recommendation: For any future enrolment windows, MahaIT should mandate Aadhaar OTP authentication as a prerequisite for GP Office and Anganwadi Centre registrations — identical to what the Nari Shakti Doot App enforces automatically. Simultaneously, Setu Suvidha Kendras should be equipped with biometric fingerprint scanners linked to the UIDAI Aadhaar API, enabling real-time gender and identity verification at point of registration.

Expected Impact: Prevention of male registrant fraud saving an estimated Rs 21 crore per scheme cycle. Reduction of duplicate registrations (currently 22% of suspension reasons). Improved data quality reducing post-enrolment audit burden on WCD field staff.

R3 Address NPCI Seeding Gap in Punjab National Bank and Co-operative Banks

MEDIUM

Data Finding: Bank-wise DBT analysis reveals Punjab National Bank has the worst DBT success rate with a 2.95% NPCI seeding gap — meaning nearly 3 in 100 active PNB account holders cannot receive their monthly Rs 1,500 benefit despite being eligible. Co-operative banks (Saraswat, Navi Mumbai) also show elevated NPCI gaps. The total monthly benefit at risk across all banks with NPCI seeding failures amounts to significant exchequer loss — not through fraud, but through infrastructure failure.

Recommendation: MahaIT's DBT operations team should issue formal notices to PNB and identified co-operative banks requiring resolution of all pending NPCI mapper seedings within 60 days. Additionally, the LadkiBahin portal should display a real-time NPCI seeding status indicator to beneficiaries, enabling self-service correction. A bank-wise DBT health dashboard (similar to what this analysis produces) should be published monthly on the MahaIT transparency portal.

Expected Impact: Recovery of benefit delivery to an estimated 56,000 beneficiaries (synthetic) currently receiving no credit despite Active status. Monthly saving of Rs 8.4 crore in failed transfer administrative costs. Improved DBT overall success rate from 72.7% to above 90%.

R4 Implement Targeted Outreach for ST Women in Remote Districts

HIGH

Data Finding: Caste-wise equity analysis reveals Scheduled Tribe women have the lowest active rate of all caste categories — a finding consistent with their geographic concentration in Gadchiroli, Nandurbar, Palghar, and Melghat — Maharashtra's most remote, forested districts. These women face compounded barriers: no smartphone for Nari Shakti Doot App, poor Aadhaar-bank linking due to distant bank branches, and Anganwadi centres understaffed relative to population. The scheme, in its current form, is least reaching the women it most needs to serve.

Recommendation: WCD and MahaIT should design a dedicated ST outreach sub-programme: monthly banking correspondent (BC) visits to tribal hamlets for on-site Aadhaar seeding and eKYC completion, empanelment of regional co-operative banks with tribal presence as preferred DBT channels, and revision of eKYC deadlines to allow rolling 90-day windows for districts classified as Schedule V areas under the Constitution.

Expected Impact: Reduction of ST active rate gap from current levels to within 2% of general category active rate. Improved social equity in scheme outcomes. Prevention of systemic exclusion of Maharashtra's most vulnerable women from a scheme designed for their welfare.

R5	Build a Real-Time MahaIT Scheme Health Dashboard for CM's Office	MEDIUM
Data Finding: The current CM's Dashboard lacks granular scheme-level monitoring — district-wise active rates, bank DBT failure alerts, eKYC completion tracking, and fraud detection signals are all computed retrospectively through manual WCD audits. The 26.34 lakh ineligible beneficiaries were only detected 11 months after the scheme launched, and male registrants received payments for an average of 10 months before detection. A real-time monitoring system could have flagged both anomalies within the first 30 days. Recommendation: MahaIT should build a live Power BI DirectQuery dashboard (architecture identical to this project) connected to the scheme's production database, refreshing daily. Key automated alerts should include: beneficiaries with eKYC expiry within 30 days, bank branches with DBT failure rate >5%, districts where new male registrations exceed 0.1% of total, and sudden single-month drops in beneficiary count exceeding 5%. This dashboard should be presented to the WCD Secretary weekly. Expected Impact: Reduction of fraud detection lag from 10 months to under 30 days. Prevention of Rs 21+ crore exchequer loss per scheme cycle. Elimination of the reactive audit model in favour of proactive real-time governance — consistent with Maharashtra's Digital India commitments.		

Note on Data: All findings are derived from a synthetic dataset of 5,00,000 records generated using real scheme parameters (eligibility criteria, district population weights, installment schedule, and published aggregate statistics). Scale factor: 1 synthetic record = 50.6 real beneficiaries. Aggregate statistics (total disbursed, fraud counts, suspension figures) are anchored to officially reported figures from WCD Department press releases, Maharashtra Budget Speech FY2024-25, and DBT Bharat portal data. This brief is prepared as part of a portfolio data analytics project and is not an official government document.